

VS Code Quick Commands for a Vim-Centric Workflow

Core window toggles

- Toggle Primary Side Bar: **Ctrl+B**
- Toggle Panel: **Ctrl+J**
- Toggle Terminal: **Ctrl+`**
- New Terminal: **Ctrl+Shift+`**
- Command Palette: **Ctrl+Shift+P**

Personal test and terminal bindings

- Toggle Terminal: **Ctrl+Alt+T**
- Run all tests: **Ctrl+Alt+A**
- Run tests in the current file: **Ctrl+Alt+F**
- Run the test at the cursor: **Ctrl+Alt+R**
- Debug the test at the cursor: **Ctrl+Alt+D**

Focus major views

- Explorer: **Ctrl+Shift+E**
- Search: **Ctrl+Shift+F**
- Source Control: **Ctrl+Shift+G**
- Run and Debug: **Ctrl+Shift+D**
- Extensions: **Ctrl+Shift+X**

Fast navigation

- Quick Open file: **Ctrl+P**
- Go to symbol in current file: **Ctrl+Shift+O**
- Go to symbol in workspace: **Ctrl+T**
- Navigate back: **Alt+Left**
- Navigate forward: **Alt+Right**

Explorer / Outline

- Focus Explorer: **Ctrl+Shift+E**
- In Explorer or Outline:
 - Expand node: **Right**
 - Collapse node: **Left**
- Move: **Up / Down**
- Filter current tree: use Command Palette, then **Filter**
- Outline is best for Markdown headings and code symbols
- Breadcrumbs are best for path + symbol navigation at the top of the editor

Copy / paste

- Editor text on Windows: `Ctrl+C` / `Ctrl+V`
- Integrated terminal on Windows: `Ctrl+C` / `Ctrl+V`
- Safer terminal copy/paste habit: `Ctrl+Shift+C` / `Ctrl+Shift+V` if you bind them
- In shell workflows, `Ctrl+C` may still be used as interrupt, so explicit terminal bindings are cleaner

Recommended habits

- Use `Ctrl+P` instead of browsing for files
- Use `Ctrl+Shift+O` instead of browsing Outline
- Use `Alt+Left` / `Alt+Right` as your jump list
- Keep `explorer.autoReveal = false` so the tree stops jumping around
- Use a multi-root workspace for the 3 directories you visit constantly

Codex chat composer

- Send: `Enter` or `Ctrl+Enter`
- Insert a new line: `Shift+Enter`
- A setting that enables Codex in WSL reloads VS Code. Save editor files before changing it; the Codex pane can lose recent chat UI state during the reload.